I was doing. Nothing much, I had replied, just packing up and moving out. Now it was his turn to be flummoxed, as he had called me up to tell me that I would be relieving him soon, but only in December. Quite naturally, he was wondering why I was packing up so early. That confusion was sorted out, but it still meant I had to shift out. If only he had called even forty-eight hours earlier, I could have avoided this double move.

By now, Isha and Simon had been dating for some time and had finally decided to get married. We were quite happy with this development, as till quite late, she was averse to the 'M' word and would avoid any discussion regarding marriage. Diwali was around the corner, so we decided to have a small engagement ceremony in the new house at Tarapore Enclave in mid-November. As it so happened, my promotion also came just then, so it was a double celebration. Isha and Simon exchanged rings and we exchanged a few token gifts between the family members, followed by high tea. We also decided that we could plan the wedding sometime in March 2016 during the Pathways School mid-term break.

By the time I took over 2 Corps in mid-December, the training year was almost half done. As per the schedule, the Corps War Game (WG) was scheduled for the first week of February 2016. As per the norm, the Chief, Gen Dalbir Singh Suhag, would be attending the WG. The Army Commander, Lt Gen KJ Singh asked me whether I wanted to get the WG postponed to get more time to settle down. It was a tempting offer. 2 Corps is a 'Strike Corps', meaning a Corps that has an offensive role and is meant to strike deep into enemy territory. The main punch of the Strike Corps lay in its mechanized formations, the 1 Armoured Division and the 16(I) Armoured Brigade. Not only would this be my first time commanding armoured formations, but the last time I had served on the

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